Root canal post-op

POLISHED FAMILY DENTAL
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How to care for your tooth after your root canal.

What to expect

Soreness, tenderness when you bite, and mild pressure sensitivity are common for a few days, and sometimes longer. The tooth and gums were inflamed or infected before treatment, and the area was worked on during your visit. If we used anesthetic, your lips, teeth and tongue may be numb for several hours: don't chew until it wears off, so you don't bite or burn yourself.

Easing discomfort

Take any antibiotic or pain medicine we prescribed exactly as directed. If your doctor says it's safe for you, an over-the-counter pain reliever such as ibuprofen or acetaminophen, taken as directed on the label, usually helps. Warm salt-water rinses (1 teaspoon salt in 8 oz water) several times a day can soothe sore gums.

Your temporary filling or crown

A temporary filling or crown protects your tooth until the permanent crown is placed. Avoid gum, hard candy, ice and sticky or chewy foods, and chew on the other side. Brush and floss gently around it. Temporaries can occasionally break or come off: if that happens, call us right away and bring the piece with you.

Your permanent crown

Teeth are fragile after a root canal and can crack if they aren't covered with a strong permanent crown. The crown also seals the tooth against bacteria and re-infection. Please schedule it as soon as we recommend: waiting too long can mean losing the tooth or needing the root canal done again.

Call us if you have:

- Swelling in your face or gums
- A fever or chills
- Severe pain that medicine doesn't relieve
- A bite that feels uneven or high
- A rash or other reaction to a medicine
- A temporary filling or crown that comes off

If swelling spreads toward your eye or neck, or you have trouble breathing or swallowing, call 911 or go to the nearest emergency room.

Questions? Phone: (254) 897-3143 · Email: glenrose@polishedfamilydental.com · polishedfamilydental.com